

Getting your Instagram photos onto the website

Instagram can send you a copy of every photo you've ever posted. You request it on your phone, Meta emails you a file, and you pass that file along. That's the whole job.

About 3 minutes of tapping

Then a wait for the email

Phone only — no computer needed

Do this part on your phone

Open the Instagram app and sign in as **@30a.maintenance** if you aren't already.

1

Open your profile

Tap your profile picture in the bottom-right corner of the screen.

2

Open the menu

Tap the three stacked lines  in the top-right corner.

3

Tap **Settings and privacy**

It's usually the first item in the list. On some versions it just says **Settings**.

4

Tap **Accounts Center**

It sits near the very top, under a heading about Meta. If you don't see it, scroll to the bottom and look for **Accounts Center** there.

5 Tap **Your information and permissions**

6 Tap **Download your information**

7 Tap **Download or transfer information**

If it asks which account, pick **30a.maintenance**, then tap **Next**.

8 Choose **Some of your information**

Then scroll down to the section headed **Your content** and tick the box next to **Posts**.

That's the only box you need. Tap **Next**.

9 Choose **Download to device**

10 **Set the three options**

This is the important screen — see below before tapping anything.

⚠️ Check these three settings

Everything else on this screen can stay as it is. These three are worth double-checking, because they're the difference between photos we can use and photos we can't.

Date range

All time

Format

JSON

Media quality

High

Format: JSON is the one people get wrong. The other option, HTML, gives us the photos but throws away your captions. **Media quality: High** matters because the lower setting shrinks your photos, and they look soft and blurry blown up on a website.

11 Tap **Create files**

That's you done for now. Instagram takes it from here.

What happens next

Meta puts the file together in the background and emails you when it's ready. It usually takes a few hours. Occasionally it takes a day or two — if you've posted a lot of photos, it takes longer.

You can close Instagram. You don't have to keep the app open or the phone awake. The email will come whether or not you're looking.

When the email arrives

It comes from Meta or Instagram with a subject line about your information being ready. Open it and tap the download button. You'll be asked to log in again — that's normal, it's checking it's really you.

You'll end up with a **.zip file**. Don't open it, don't unzip it, don't rename it. Just leave it as it is.

Don't sit on it too long. The download link expires after a few days. If you miss the window, no harm done — just run through the steps again.

Last step: send the file over

The zip is usually too big to email. Any of these work:

- **Google Drive or Dropbox** — upload it, then share the link.
- **WeTransfer** — free, no account needed, made for exactly this.
- **AirDrop** — if you're both on iPhones and in the same room.
- **Text message** — worth a try, but it'll likely be too large.

Once it's sent, you're finished. Every photo goes up on the website from there.

If something looks different

The menus don't match what's written here

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Instagram rearranges these screens every so often. The wording tends to survive even when the layout changes, so look for the phrases "**Accounts Center**", then "**Your information and permissions**", then "**Download your information**". Following those three phrases will get you there from almost any version of the app.

I can't find Accounts Center anywhere

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Try scrolling all the way to the bottom of the Settings screen — on some versions it sits at the end rather than the top. Failing that, you can do the whole thing on a computer at **accountscenter.instagram.com**, where the same options appear under "Your information and permissions".

I already tapped through and picked the wrong settings

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Not a problem. Nothing is lost and there's no limit on requests — just start again from step 1 and request a new one. The wrong file can be ignored.

It's asking me to pick between accounts

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Choose **30a.maintenance**. If a personal Instagram or a Facebook page is linked to the same login, they'll show up in the same list — you only want the business account.

How long is this going to take?

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The tapping is about three minutes. The wait for the email is a few hours, sometimes longer. You don't have to do anything during the wait.

Any trouble at all, stop and send a screenshot of whatever's on your screen — much easier to sort out that way than guessing.